

KANNAN SANTHARAM

Senior Lead Frontend Engineer | React · TypeScript · AI-Native Engineering

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Nationality: Indian | Visa Status: Employment Visa Sponsorship Required | Notice Period: 60 Days

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Lead Frontend Engineer with 10.5 years of experience delivering high-performance web applications, monorepos, and scalable client architectures for global SaaS products. Specialised in AI-driven development and agentic workflows — LLM orchestration, custom Claude Code skills, MCP integrations and SSE streaming built into enterprise platforms. Proven record of leading solo platform migrations, cutting build compilation time by 96%, and setting engineering standards and safety guardrails across distributed frontend teams. Seeking a Lead Frontend Engineer / Engineering Manager role with a product-led technology company in Dubai, UAE.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- Reduced cold-start build compilation from 2 minutes to 5 seconds — a 96% improvement — through a solo Webpack 5 to Rspack migration completed in 3 weeks.
- Built an AI test-authoring platform from zero, using LLM agents over SSE streaming to auto-generate, execute, and self-heal end-to-end test suites.
- Authored custom production Claude Code skills using MCP code-graphs, with strict write-scope guardrails securing autonomous agent workflows across the codebase.
- Developed and maintained a 232-spec Playwright regression suite protecting release quality.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI & Agentic Tooling: Claude Code, Model Context Protocol (MCP), Cursor IDE, LLM Orchestration, Server-Sent Events (SSE), Agent Guardrails & Write-Scope Design

Frontend Core: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, SASS, Tailwind CSS

State & Data: GraphQL, Apollo Client, Zustand, REST API Design

Architecture: Monorepos, Micro-Frontends, Design Systems, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Module Federation

Build & Performance: Rspack, Webpack 5, Code Splitting, Knip Static Analysis, Bundle Optimisation

Testing, Cloud & DevOps: Playwright, Node.js, Jenkins CI/CD, Automated Regression Suites, AWS (EC2, S3, Route 53), Amazon Bedrock AgentCore

Leadership: Technical Leadership, Architecture & Design Reviews, Engineering Standards, Mentoring, Cross-Cultural Collaboration, Stakeholder Communication

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Lead Frontend Engineer

Jul 2022 – Present

SuperOps — Chennai, India

Progression: Senior Frontend Engineer → Lead Frontend Engineer → Senior Lead Frontend Engineer

- Architected an AI test-authoring platform from zero using React and Node.js, orchestrating LLM agents over streaming SSE to auto-generate, run, and self-heal end-to-end test suites.
- Authored custom production Claude Code skills via MCP code-graphs and enforced strict write-scope guardrails, securing autonomous agent workflows across the codebase.
- Executed a solo Webpack 5 to Rspack migration in 3 weeks, reducing cold-start build compilation from 2 minutes to 5 seconds across 12 packages.
- Improved application load times through React lazy loading, route-level code splitting and per-package chunking strategy across the monorepo.
- Maintained platform health with a 232-spec Playwright regression suite and Knip static analysis, stripping 30k lines of dead code from the monorepo.

- Sole-authored a reusable API / UI SDK integration framework adopted across product teams, standardising how features consume platform services.
- Built role-based access control (RBAC) gates and high-frequency polling dashboards using custom cached Apollo query hooks, balancing data freshness against network load.

Senior Software Engineer

Jun 2018 – Jul 2022

Freshworks — Chennai, India

Progression: Onboarding Engineer → Senior Software Engineer | Customer-facing engineering role

- Worked directly with customers alongside Support, Customer Success and Sales teams to understand use cases and requirements, then partnered with Product Design to deliver the resulting UI.
- Built UI web pages and REST API services across Freshworks products using React, JavaScript, Node.js, HTML and SASS.
- Built a Customer 360 dashboard consolidating all of a customer's information into a single operational view.
- Integrated enterprise SaaS platforms — Jira, Salesforce, Zendesk and ServiceNow — with Freshworks products through REST API services.
- Implemented multiple Freshworks add-ons and supporting REST API services to solve customer-specific use cases.
- Created UI wireframes and design mockups in Balsamiq; mentored engineers on add-on development and led code and UI design reviews.

Software Developer

Jan 2018 – Jun 2018

Infogenic, LLC — Bengaluru, India

- Designed and implemented company web pages and landing pages.
- Built an integration connecting Freshservice with DocuSign using REST API services; the product was subsequently acquired by Freshworks.

Web Application Developer & Designer

Mar 2016 – Dec 2017

Niche Video Media, LLC — Chennai, India

- Designed and implemented web pages, landing pages, and plugins for a commercial video-hosting platform.
- Built a video player customisation feature from scratch — configurable player buttons, annotations and call-to-action overlays.
- Implemented an admin dashboard that dynamically generated Stripe pricing plans based on feature selection, storage, and bandwidth tiers.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Science

2011 – 2015

K.L.N. College of Information Technology, Tamil Nadu, India

LANGUAGES

English — Fluent (professional working proficiency) · Tamil — Native · Hindi — Basic